

Take Control: Protect Yourself from Falls Carolyn Silan, PT

Therapeutic Connection
PHYSICAL THERAPY AND WELLNESS

1. **The stakes are real -** Falls significantly increase mortality risk, and hip fractures are especially dangerous: up to 30% of people who fracture their hip die within one year.
2. **How you move matters -** Changes in your walking pattern or posture are red flags for fall risk.
3. **Surprising culprits -** Even diabetes, depression and autoimmune diseases increase fall risk through frozen shoulder and neuropathy. Managing these conditions protects your stability.
4. **Medication alert -** Taking more than 5 medications significantly raises your fall risk. A medication review could be your best safety step.
5. **The #1 predictor: previous falls -** Fallen in the last year? Your risk of falling again is significantly higher. Talk to Carolyn for personalized guidance - don't wait.
6. **Use it or lose it -** Physical inactivity leads straight to muscle weakness and balance problems, creating a dangerous cycle.
7. **Simple hazards like loose rugs or poor lighting cause preventable falls!!** Go to my website for a Home Safety Checklist at https://therapeuticconnection.com/events.

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